

ADVENTURE FOR THE FIFTH EDITION (2024) · WARCRAFT SETTING

THE ANVIL OF THE FIRST NAME

a campaign about the origin of a people and who gets to tell it

CAMPAIGN · FOUR TO FIVE CHARACTERS · LEVELS 1 TO 10

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Credits

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Introduction

> *"They told you that you are stone gone soft. I tell you that flesh is the first true word ever spoken about us."*
> — Othrek Brokenvoice

Premise

A D&D campaign set in *Warcraft* for 4–5 Alliance characters, from 1st to 10th level, over some 16–20 sessions. It takes place in Khaz Modan, the heartland of the dwarves, shortly after the Cataclysm.

The earth is still shaking weeks after Deathwing burst out of the depths. The rifts have opened crypts sealed for millennia, and out of them pour maddened troggs, crystals of a sickly violet and whispers no one should hear.

In those crypts lie the **Runes of Form**, three pieces of a titan artifact: the **Anvil of the First Name**. According to the lore the characters will uncover, it was on this anvil that the Makers inscribed the original form of the earthen, the stone dwarves from whom today's dwarves descend. Whoever reawakens it could "reinscribe" an entire people.

Othrek Brokenvoice, once a scholar of the Explorers' League and now a prophet of the Twilight's Hammer, intends to do exactly that: gather the runes, bring the Anvil to the heart of Grim Batol and remake the dwarves of Ironforge as servants of the Old Gods. To him it is not betrayal but revelation.

Themes and tone

- **Origin as a battlefield.** The question "where do we come from?" is never innocent: whoever controls the story of the origin controls the people's identity. Othrek isn't entirely lying, and that makes him dangerous.
- **Unity against suspicion.** The Dark Iron dwarves have only just joined the Council of Three Hammers. The cult will exploit that mistrust.
- **Exploration and wonder.** Titan ruins, machinery that still works, libraries of metal discs. The campaign rewards curiosity as much as combat.
- **Contained cosmic horror.** The Old Gods are hinted at, never shown. The optional Void Whispers rule lets you tune that intensity.

A contested origin myth. If *The Fall of Quel'Thalas* was a tragedy and *The Mine of the Absent Foreman* a comedy, this campaign is a disputed theogony: two rival accounts of a people's birth, the titans' and the Void's, and a villain who wants his to become flesh. The Watcher of Uldaman sums up the campaign in one question: *who decides what the true form of a living thing is?*

Visible and hidden plot

Visible plot. Stay ahead of the Twilight's Hammer from the shores of Loch Modan to the ruins of Uldaman, unravel a conspiracy in the depths of Ironforge and, finally, storm Grim Batol in the Twilight Highlands.

Hidden plot. Othrek already holds the base anvil in Grim Batol and has a mole in the Hall of Explorers: the archivist Bramdul, who has been promised the return of his dead daughter. The third rune was never hidden: it is on display in Ironforge as a curiosity, and Bramdul has swapped it for a replica. The full details are in "The Hidden Truth."

Campaign structure

Chapter	Levels	Setting	Goal	Sessions
1. Tremors in Loch Modan	1–3	Thelsamar, the dam, the Clay Crypt	Rescue Helga and recover the Clay Rune	3–4
2. The Heart of Uldaman	4–6	Badlands, Uldaman	Recover the Stone Rune before the cult	4–5
3. Cracks in Ironforge	6–8	Ironforge, Deeprun Tram	Unmask the mole and protect the Metal Rune	4–5
4. The Anvil of Grim Batol	8–10	Twilight Highlands, Grim Batol	Stop the reinscription ritual	4–5

Table tools

Milestone advancement. The characters gain levels at the end of the key scenes, marked in the text with the symbol ▲. That way the narrative pace doesn't depend on counting experience points.

Reputation. A tracker from −3 to +3 for four factions: **League**, **Council**, **Wildhammer** and **Dark Iron**. All start at 0 (Dark Iron at −1 if no character belongs to that clan). The text says when it rises or falls.

Reputation

Value	Effect
−3 / −2	Open hostility or coldness: prices doubled, no help, possible denunciations.
−1 / 0 / +1	Neutral treatment. At +1 they offer useful information or a 10% discount.
+2	Allies: an NPC of the faction travels with the group once per chapter or lends an uncommon item.
+3	Honoured: the faction joins the final assault (see Chapter 4).

Void Whispers (optional rule). Each character has a Whispers score from 0 to 6. They gain 1 point when touching an Old God artifact directly, failing a saving throw against an effect marked as a *whisper*, reading forbidden texts or accepting a power from the Void. They lose 1 point when finishing a Long Rest in a place consecrated to the Light or the titans, when receiving *Lesser Restoration* within a 10-minute ritual, or when the player roleplays a meaningful scene of support with another character.

Void Whispers

Whispers	Effect
2	Restless sleep: when you finish a Long Rest, roll 1d6; on a 1, you regain no Hit Point Dice.
4	Each time you gain another point, you suffer a Void Echo (next table). You hear your name in voices that don't exist.
6	The Void offers you a deal: the Game Master privately proposes a specific power at a narrative price. If you accept, you gain the power and a permanent Echo, cured only by *Greater Restoration* or the end of the campaign.

Void Echoes

1d6	Void Echo (lasts 1 minute)
1	You hear the heartbeat of the stone. You have Disadvantage on Wisdom (Perception) checks.
2	Your hands seem to belong to someone else. You have Disadvantage on attack rolls.
3	You murmur the last sentence you heard. You can't cast spells with a Verbal component.
4	You see eyes in the walls. You have the Frightened condition with respect to the nearest creature.
5	You feel you must touch the nearest magic item and must move towards it.
6	A terrible calm. You can't take Reactions.

Safety at the table

Cosmic horror works best when it is agreed on. We recommend a session zero with safety tools (lines and veils, the X-card) and agreeing how far the theme of losing one's identity may go.

A note on the era

The campaign is set shortly after the Cataclysm, but it is easy to move. For a "classic" game, replace the Twilight's Hammer with the Defias Brotherhood or Thaurissan's Dark Irons and move the finale to Blackrock Mountain. For a later era, the Old Gods can take shape as N'Zoth's influence.

Setting names

This edition uses the names from the English version of *World of Warcraft*. The Spanish edition of the campaign uses the Spanish localisation; the table helps when playing with both.

In this campaign	Spanish edition
Khaz Modan	Khaz Modan
Ironforge	Forjaz
Loch Modan	Loch Modan
Dun Morogh	Dun Morogh
Badlands	Tierras Inhóspitas
Twilight Highlands	Tierras Altas Crepusculares
Deeprun Tram	Tranvía Subterráneo
Twilight's Hammer	Martillo Crepuscular
Explorers' League	Liga de Expedicionarios
Council of Three Hammers	Consejo de los Tres Martillos
Dark Iron / Wildhammer	Hierro Negro / Martillo Salvaje
Reliquary	Relicario
Deathwing	Alamuerte
Earthen / Curse of Flesh	Terráneos / Maldición de la Carne
Faceless One	Sin Rostro

Lore moment

After the Cataclysm, Ironforge is ruled by the Council of Three Hammers: Muradin Bronzebeard for the Bronzebeards, Moira Thaurissan for the Dark Irons and Falstad Wildhammer for the Wildhammers. The alliance is recent and fragile. At the same time, the dwarves have rediscovered their bond with the earth and the earthen, and the Twilight's Hammer has made Grim Batol its stronghold.



FOR THE GAME MASTER

Tracking sheet

Campaign record

Reputation

Dark Iron starts at –1 if no character belongs to the clan.

Explorers' League	–3	–2	–1	**0**	+1	+2	+3
Council of Three Hammers	–3	–2	–1	**0**	+1	+2	+3
Wildhammer	–3	–2	–1	**0**	+1	+2	+3
Dark Iron	–3	–2	–1	**0**	+1	+2	+3

Void Whispers

At 2: restless sleep. At 4: Void Echo. At 6: the deal.

PC 1 _____	**0**	1	2	3	4	5	6
PC 2 _____	**0**	1	2	3	4	5	6
PC 3 _____	**0**	1	2	3	4	5	6
PC 4 _____	**0**	1	2	3	4	5	6
PC 5 _____	**0**	1	2	3	4	5	6

Crisis Clock (Ch. 3)

1	2	3	4	5	6

Advances with each Long Rest or failure by 5 or more. At 2: graffiti. At 3: mob. At 4: Moira threatens. At 6: Bramdul escapes.

Reinscription ritual (Ch. 4)

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8

+1 per lit ring at the end of each round. At 8: the prisoners transform.

Runes of Form (who carries it)

☐ Clay Rune (Ch. 1) · _____

☐ Stone Rune (Ch. 2) · _____

☐ Metal Rune (Ch. 3) · _____

Decisions that matter

☐ Quarry troggs spared (Ch. 1)

☐ Truce with the Reliquary (Ch. 2)

☐ Dark Iron renegade captured alive (Ch. 2)

☐ Grel bribed instead of defeated (Ch. 2)

☐ Bramdul won over with compassion (Ch. 3)

☐ Wildhammer clan support (Ch. 4)

☐ Helga alive on reaching Grim Batol

The party

Character	Species and class	Level	Tie to the theme of origin

Azeroth at the table

> *"Dwarves don't worship the stone. They remember it."*
> — Helga Finestone

A guide to creating Alliance characters with the 2024 rules. Options from the SRD 5.2 are marked as such; the rest refer to the 2024 *Player's Handbook*, which each table will consult on its own. This campaign doesn't reproduce the text of those options.

Species

In Warcraft	In D&D 2024	Adjustments and notes
Human (Stormwind, Kul Tiras, Gilneas)	Human (SRD)	Soldiers, priests of the Light, mages of Dalaran. A Kul Tiran can choose a sailor background.
Ironforge dwarf	Dwarf (SRD)	Many belong to the Explorers' League. Languages: Common and Dwarvish.
Dark Iron dwarf	Dwarf (SRD)	Swap poison resistance for fire resistance. They will face mistrust in Chapter 3: a great dramatic opportunity.
Wildhammer dwarf	Dwarf (SRD)	Gryphon riders and shamans. Animal Handling proficiency from their background. Key allies in Chapter 4.
Gnome	Rock gnome (SRD)	Exiles of Gnomeregan, brilliant engineers.
Night elf	Elf, wood elf lineage (SRD)	Sentinels and druids of the Cenarion Circle. They distrust arcane magic.
Draenei	Aasimar (*Player's Handbook*)	Newly arrived from the Exodar. The radiant damage of their revelation stands for the Light of the naaru. They may have prophetic visions: a good hook.
Worgen	Human (SRD) + *Worgen Form* trait	Refugees from Gilneas. Their curse speaks to the campaign's theme: being "reinscribed" against one's will.

Species trait: Worgen Form

As a Bonus Action, you take on your bestial form for 1 minute; you can do so once per Long Rest. While it lasts, your Speed increases by 10 feet, you gain Temporary Hit Points equal to your level, you have Advantage on Wisdom (Perception) checks that rely on smell, and your claws are natural weapons that deal 1d6 + your Strength modifier Slashing damage. You can return to human form as a Bonus Action.

Classes

In Warcraft	In D&D 2024	Comment
Warrior	Fighter: Champion (SRD) or Battle Master	Veterans of the Third War or of the Stormwind army.
Paladin	Paladin: Devotion (SRD) or Glory	Knights of the Silver Hand. The Light replaces the gods as a source of power.
Priest	Cleric: Life (SRD) or Light	Church of the Holy Light. A shadow priest can be an Aberrant Sorcery sorcerer, with Whispers.
Mage	Wizard: Evoker (SRD), Abjurer or Diviner	Trained in Dalaran or Stormwind, in the service of the Kirin Tor.
Warlock	Warlock: Fiend (SRD)	Grudgingly tolerated. Avoid the Great Old One unless the player wants an arc of temptation.
Rogue	Rogue: Thief (SRD), Assassin or Arcane Trickster	SI:7 agents, smugglers from Booty Bay.
Hunter	Ranger: Hunter (SRD) or Beast Master	Dwarven mountaineers with their bear or ram, elven sentinels.
Shaman	Druid: Circle of the Land (SRD) or of the Sea	The dwarves have just rediscovered shamanism: a direct link to the earthen.
Druid	Druid: Circle of the Land (SRD) or of the Moon	Cenarion Circle. Very useful in Chapter 2.
Engineer (profession)	Rogue or wizard with an artisan background	Gnomes and dwarves. If the table uses the artificer from an official supplement, it fits perfectly.

Magic and the sacred

Azeroth has no pantheon of gods who answer prayers. We suggest these sources of power:

- **The Holy Light:** faith in virtues (respect, tenacity, compassion), not in a personal god. Clerics and paladins.
- **The Arcane:** magic of study, addictive and dangerous in excess. Wizards.
- **The Elements and Nature:** spirits of earth, fire, water and air; the Emerald Dream. Druids and "shamans."
- **The Fel:** demonic, corrupting energy. Warlocks.
- **The Void and Shadow:** the power of the Old Gods. It is the campaign's central threat.

The dwarves also revere the **titans** and their Keepers: Khaz'goroth, Norgannon, Archaedas. A dwarven cleric may

have Khaz'goroth, the Shaper, as patron; use the Life or Light domain and present their spells as blessings of the forge.

Factions

Faction	Role in the campaign	Contact
Explorers' League	Main sponsor. Provides missions, maps and gear.	Helga Finestone
Council of Three Hammers	Government of Ironforge. Political stage of Chapter 3.	Moira, Muradin and Falstad (cameos)
SI:7	Stormwind intelligence; investigates the cult on its own.	Agent Mara Voss
Wildhammer clan	Air support for the final assault.	Thane Kergan Highwind
Twilight's Hammer	Antagonist. Apocalyptic cult serving the Old Gods.	Othrek Brokenvoice
Reliquary (Horde)	Rivals in Uldaman. Possible allies of convenience.	Magistrix Caelinde Sunshadow

FOR THE GAME MASTER ONLY

The hidden truth

> *"Three words made the stone."*
> — Titan inscription

The Anvil of the First Name

When the titans ordered Azeroth, the Keeper Khaz'goroth forged the earthen in Ulduar. To keep their form stable, they created a lesser artifact, the Anvil of the First Name, which inscribed a runic "matrix" in each earthen. When the Curse of Flesh, the work of the Old Gods, turned stone into flesh, the Anvil lost its purpose and the Keepers dismantled it into three Runes of Form, hidden in three warding vaults of Khaz Modan:

- **Clay Rune (form):** beneath the bed of Loch Modan, in a crypt the great dam kept submerged. The Cataclysm has exposed it.
- **Stone Rune (memory):** in the depths of Uldaman, guarded by a titan Watcher.
- **Metal Rune (will):** found decades ago by the League without knowing what it was; it is displayed as a curiosity in Ironforge's Hall of Explorers.

Gathered and placed on the base anvil, which the cult has already moved to Grim Batol, the runes can reinscribe the matrix of everyone who shares the "lineage of stone": that is, every dwarf.

Fact, hypothesis and interpretation. That the dwarves descend from the earthen and that the Curse of Flesh was the work of the Old Gods is established *Warcraft* lore. The Anvil, the three runes and their power are this campaign's invention. And Othrek's conclusion, that the dwarves are "children of the Void," is an interpretation: the campaign neither confirms nor refutes it, and leaves it for the players to argue.

Othrek Brokenvoice

Othrek was a brilliant League scholar, a specialist in the discs of Uldaman. When the discs revealed that the dwarves descended from the earthen, he kept pulling the thread and reached a conclusion nobody wanted to hear: if flesh was the work of the Old Gods, then today's dwarves are children of the Void as much as of the titans. Humiliated by the Hall of Explorers, he withdrew. During the Cataclysm he was trapped for three days in a rift in Dun Morogh, where the whispers spoke to him. He came out convinced of his mission.

His plan is not to destroy the dwarves but to "complete" them: to finish the work the Curse began. He is a fanatic, but also a wounded man who believes he is right. Play him with dignity and with arguments that unsettle the players.

> **Othrek, in his own words.** "They told you that you are stone gone soft. That flesh is a disease, a curse. I tell you that flesh is the first true word ever spoken about us. The titans made us tools. They made us alive."

How the cult moves

Chapter	What the cult does	What happens if no one stops it
1	Vessa the Ash opens the Clay Crypt with League prisoners.	Vessa flees with the Clay Rune; she must be chased through the trogg tunnels.
2	Grel Halfgloom waits for others to convince the Watcher, then steals the rune on the way out.	Grel takes the Stone Rune if he wins the ambush.
3	Bramdul swaps the Metal Rune for a replica and the cell stirs hatred against the Dark Irons.	Bramdul escapes with the runes through the Deeprun Tram.
4	Othrek begins the ritual in Grim Batol with dwarven prisoners.	The prisoners transform and the effect spreads towards Ironforge.

Dramatis personae

> *"You're late, but not entirely."*
> — Helga Finestone

Each entry includes a description to read aloud the first time the character appears, and notes for the Game Master. The named characters were invented for this campaign, except the *Warcraft* characters who appear as cameos: Moira Thaurissan, Muradin Bronzebeard, Falstad Wildhammer and Brann Bronzebeard.

Othrek Brokenvoice, the prophet

First appearance: Chapter 1, as a projection; in person, Chapter 4.

> A dwarf with a grey beard braided in the old League fashion, a scholar's silver beads still caught in the braids. He wears scale armour of a matte violet that doesn't reflect the light. His eyes don't blink. He speaks slowly, like a teacher repeating a lesson to a pupil who is finally about to understand it.

Notes. The antagonist. Fanatical, wounded and brilliant. His strength is his argument, not his Hit Points: if the players hesitate, the campaign works. Stat block in Appendix A.

Helga Finestone, League archaeologist

First appearance: Chapter 1, in the Clay Crypt.

> A dwarf in her sixties with grey hair in a thick braid, hands scarred by chisels and an unlit briar pipe between her teeth, even in chains. She looks you up and down like a find of doubtful authenticity.

Notes. Sarcastic, brave and guilty: she was Othrek's pupil and turned her back on him when the Hall humiliated him. She is the best ally against his argument in the final battle. She gives her hammer to whoever helped her most (Appendix B).

Sergeant Tobrin Merryhammer

First appearance: Chapter 1, in Thelsamar.

> A stout dwarf with ruddy cheeks and a blond beard, his mail badly buckled and his eyes ringed by three sleepless nights. He smiles out of habit, though the smile no longer reaches his eyes.

Notes. Cheerful and overwhelmed by the troggs. Contact for Chapter 1; he may return with the Thelsamar guard in the final assault.

Zixxle Wirecutter, gnome engineer

First appearance: Chapter 1, in the ruined camp.

> A gnome with singed green hair climbs out of a barrel hugging a brass contraption covered in dials. The contraption beeps. So does the gnome: "It's beeping! Beeping like mad! That's a good sign. Or a very bad one."

Notes. Comic relief. His "titanicity detector" really works, sometimes. He can travel with the group as a support NPC or serve as a spare character.

Agent Mara Voss, of SI:7

First appearance: Chapter 2, shadowing the group; she introduces herself in Chapter 3.

> A short-haired human in a grey travelling coat who always seems to be at the edge of the scene: by the door, at the end of the bar, behind the last tent. When she finally speaks, she does so quietly and without wasting time.

Notes. Cold and professional. She suspects a mole in the Hall of Explorers and reaches the same conclusion as the group by another route.

Ambassador Kadra Smokeforge

First appearance: Chapter 3, in Ironforge.

> A Dark Iron dwarf with ash-grey skin and ember eyes, dressed with the sobriety of someone who knows any ornament will be used against her. She keeps her chin high while the crowd insults her.

Notes. Moira's diplomat. Her clan will be falsely accused; if the characters support her, she becomes a decisive ally and can push back the Crisis Clock.

Archivist Bramdul Drytome

First appearance: Chapter 3, in the Hall of Explorers.

> A kindly old dwarf with thick spectacles and fingers stained with ink and parchment dust. He offers you tea before you ask anything and remembers every apprentice's name.

Notes. The cult's mole. He has been promised his daughter back, killed in the Cataclysm. He is not evil; he may break down if spoken to with compassion.

Vessa the Ash

First appearance: Chapter 1, in the Rune Niche.

> A young human with a shaved head and a mud-stained violet robe, the skin of her forearms covered in fine cracks that glow like purple embers. She chants without pause, and when she sees you she doesn't stop chanting: she only smiles.

Notes. Devoted acolyte of the Twilight's Hammer and villain of Chapter 1. Stat block in Appendix A.

Grel Halfgloom

First appearance: Chapter 2, in the final ambush.

> A blue-skinned ogre, taller than the doorway he steps out of, with a single horn carved with runes and a smile of filed teeth. He wears rings on every finger and clinks them as he speaks, as if counting coins.

Notes. An ogre mage serving the cult, cunning and greedy. He can be bribed. Use the oni stat block from the SRD 5.2.

Magistrix Caelinde Sunshadow, of the Reliquary

First appearance: Chapter 2, at the Uldaman dig.

> A blood elf with copper hair and a crimson-and-gold robe, without a speck of dust despite the canyon. She greets you with an exact nod, not one degree more than you deserve.

Notes. An elegant Horde rival. She wants the Stone Rune to study it, not for the cult. None of her people wants to die in Uldaman.

Thane Kergan Highwind

First appearance: Chapter 4, at the Wildhammer stronghold.

> A red-bearded dwarf with blue tattoos on his arms and neck and gryphon feathers braided into his hair. He receives you without dismounting.

Notes. He distrusts "city dwarves," but he hates the cult more. His support opens the aerial route of the assault.

Others

- **Dagna Oldiron**, the prospector running the League camp at Uldaman.
- **Barga Soothammer**, leader of the Dark Iron renegades. Use the bandit captain stat block from the SRD 5.2.
- **Pibbly Eclipsby**, a terrified gnome seer in Ironforge's Mystic Ward.
- **Grimlok the Old**, trogg warlord of Uldaman, familiar to *Warcraft* players.

Locations

> *"The mountain has seen you."*
> — Wildhammer saying

Descriptions to read aloud on arriving at each place, in order of appearance. The numbers refer to the maps.

Thelsamar and the lake (Chapter 1)

> The road winds down through pine and granite until the lake appears before you, but not as the songs describe it. The water has drawn back dozens of metres, leaving a belt of grey mud dotted with stranded boats. In the distance, the great dwarven dam bears an open wound from top to bottom. Thelsamar smells of peat smoke and fear: the windows are boarded up and the guards carry their hammers in hand, not at their belts.

The ruined camp (Chapter 1)

> The League tents are torn and the mud is trampled by dozens of boots. There are overturned toolboxes, a theodolite snapped in two and, nailed to the central pole, a violet banner showing a black hammer over a circle of stars.

The slab in the lakebed (C1)

> Half a kilometre from the shore, in the exposed mud, a three-metre slab of greenish metal has been forced open with crowbars. Its edges don't have a single notch. From it a staircase descends, its steps far too large for dwarven feet.

The Badlands (Chapter 2)

> Reddish rock as far as the eye can see, canyons that open like wounds and a heat that makes the horizon shimmer. The wind carries fine sand that gets into your eyes and the joints of your armour. Now and then an enormous shadow crosses the sky, and nobody wants to look up to see what casts it.

The face of Uldaman (U1)

> At the end of a canyon rises a colossal facade carved into the rock: two faceless figures, hands joined, flank a door that seems made for giants. At their feet, a camp of blue and gold canvas ringed by palisades. And on the other side of the canyon, less than two hundred metres away, another camp, red and gold, flying the phoenix banner of Silvermoon.

The Watcher's Hall (U7)

> The ceiling is lost in darkness. In the centre, seated on a basalt throne, a giant of stone and metal watches you with two blue embers for eyes. Its chest has an opening shaped like a rune.

Ironforge (Chapter 3)

> The gates of Ironforge open onto a city carved inside the mountain, lit by the glow of the Great Forge. Heat, hammering and the smell of metal envelop you. But something has changed: in Three Hammers Square a red-bearded speaker shouts to a crowd that "the Dark Irons are selling their own people to the cultists," and the guard does nothing to silence him.

The Deeprun Tram (Chapter 3)

> A tunnel of iron and thick glass beneath the sea. Through the windows you see the shadows of huge fish and the green glow of maintenance lamps. The cars rattle over the rails with a rhythm that gets into your bones, and the air smells of oil and salt.

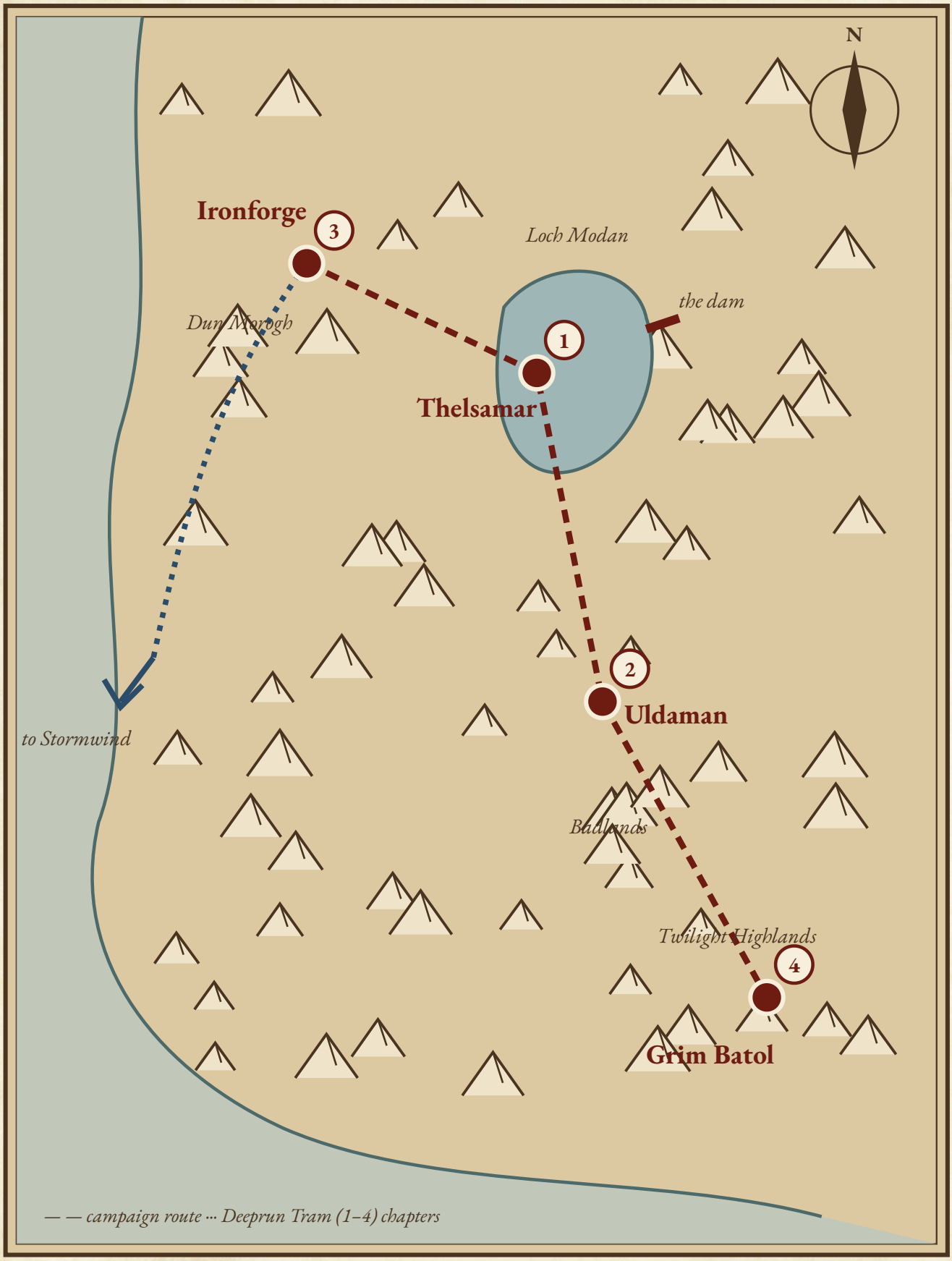
The Twilight Highlands (Chapter 4)

> From the gryphon's back, the Highlands spread out like torn green cloth: Wildhammer villages with slate roofs, burned forests, and to the east a black mountain crowned by violet clouds that turn without wind. Grim Batol. Even at this distance, something at the back of your neck knows the mountain has seen you.

The Anvil Hall (G3)

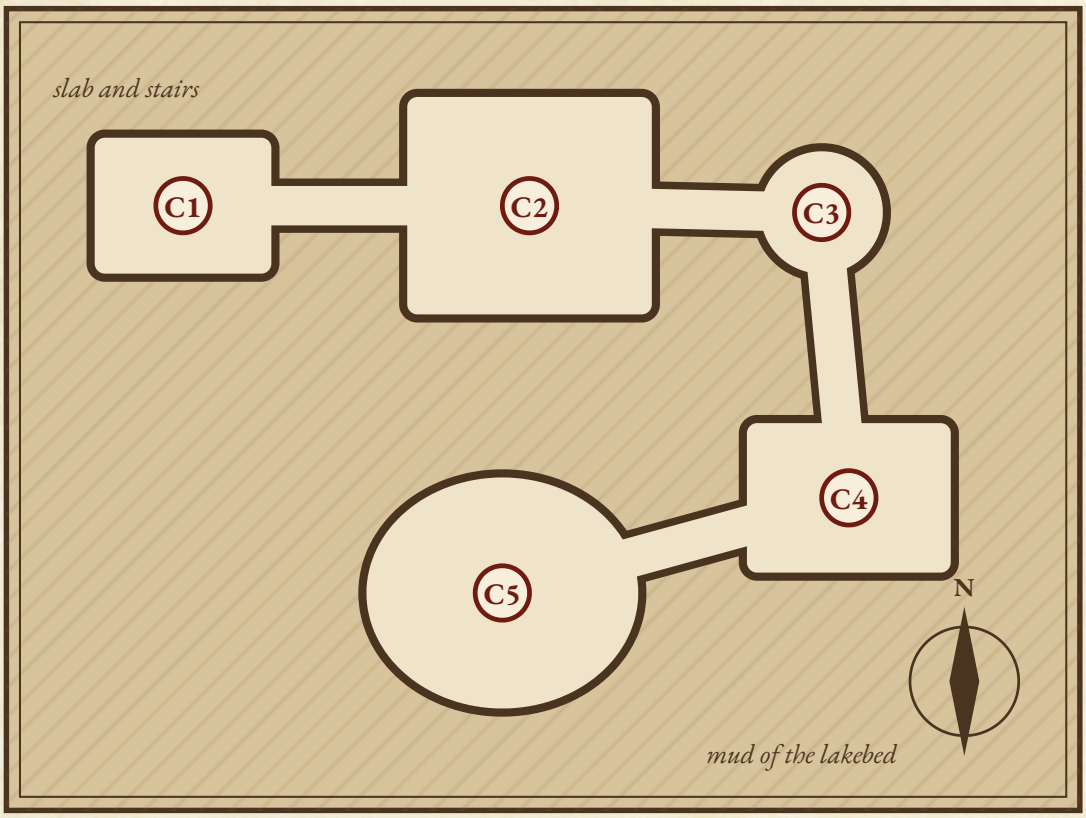
> The cavern is so large it has its own weather: a fine rain of violet ash falls from an unseen ceiling. In the centre, on a basalt platform, stands a bronze anvil the size of a house, ringed by three rings of turning runes. Chained around it, some twenty captured Ironforge and Dark Iron dwarves murmur in unison.

Maps



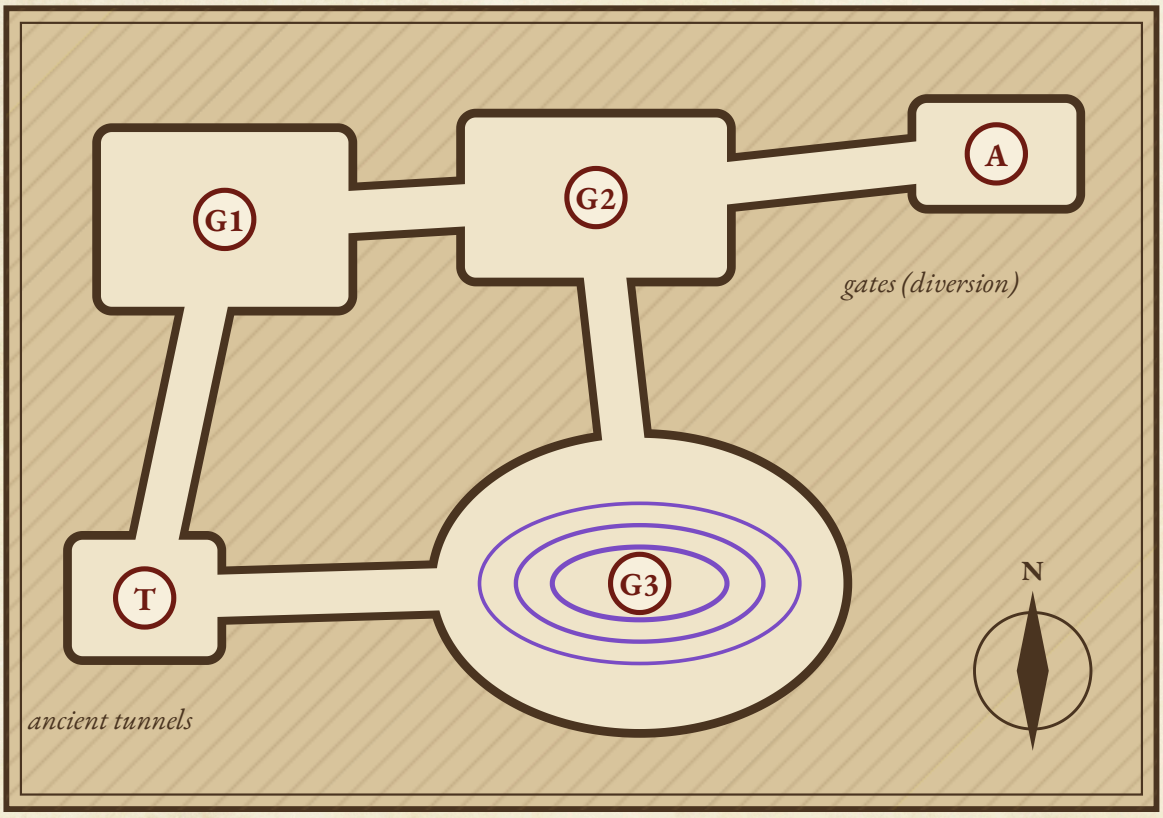
Khaz Modan, campaign outline. Distances are not to scale.

The Clay Crypt (Chapter 1)

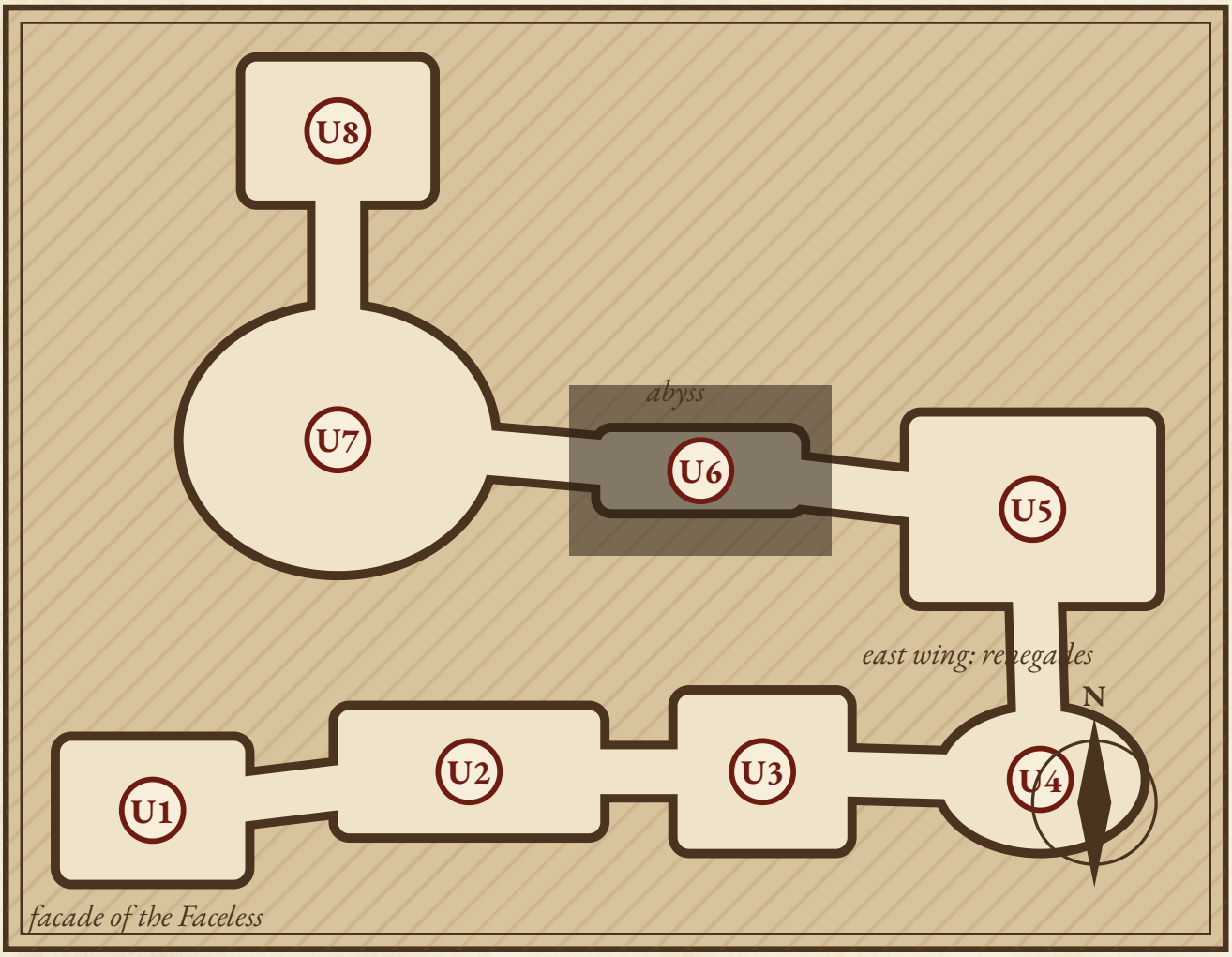


C1 Water Vestibule · C2 Gallery of the Sleepers · C3 The Song of Form · C4 Hall of Moulds · C5 The Rune Niche.

Grim Batol (Chapter 4)



A Aerial landing · T Ancient tunnels · G1 Hatching Halls · G2 Hall of the Forgotten Kings · G3 The Anvil Hall. The main gates, to the north, are the target of the diversion.



U1 Gate of the Faceless · U2 Trogg Gallery · U3 Hall of the Custodians · U4 Map Chamber · U5 Library of Discs · U6 Bridge over the Abyss · U7 The Watcher's Hall · U8 Chamber of the Mould. The bridge (U6) crosses a bottomless pit. The east wing, where the Dark Iron renegades dig, branches off U4.

Chapter 1: Tremors in Loch Modan

> *"The purple ones cut the stone that sings."*
> — A QUARRY TROGG

The characters arrive in Thelsamar, a dwarven village on the lake of Loch Modan, answering a call from the Explorers' League. The archaeologist Helga Finestone has vanished after reporting a titan crypt exposed by the falling lake. After facing maddened troggs and following the trail of some cultists, the group discovers the Clay Crypt, rescues Helga and secures the first Rune of Form.

Rule of the chapter
Reputation. Explain the tracker in session zero. Only the League moves here, and it gives the players a first proof that compassion has consequences.

Opening hooks

1d4	Hook
1	The characters are League recruits sent to escort Helga. They arrive late.
2	The Council of Three Hammers has asked for volunteers to support the Thelsamar guard against the troggs.
3	A draenei or priest character has dreamed of "an anvil that sings under the water."
4	A relative or mentor of a character worked on Helga's dig and has stopped writing.

If the group are strangers, you can start *in medias res*: they are all travelling in the same ram caravan to Thelsamar when a tremor collapses part of the road and three troggs (Appendix A) appear.

Scene 1: Thelsamar

1. **Arrival** (read "Thelsamar and the lake").
2. **Sergeant Tobrin Merryhammer** receives the group at the inn. He explains that the troggs come out of the rifts every night, that they have attacked two farms and that Helga left five days ago for her camp on the north shore, "to look at some titan thing the lake has brought to light." Nobody has heard from her since.
3. **Rumours.** Each character who asks around the room rolls on the table.

1d6	Rumour	True?
1	"The troggs carry purple stones that glow in the dark."	Yes: twilight crystals.
2	"Preachers in violet robes came through announcing the end of form."	Yes: cultists.
3	"The dam broke because the Dark Irons sabotaged it."	No. It was the Cataclysm. A first sign of the suspicion that will explode in Ironforge.
4	"Stone dwarf statues, older than Ironforge, have turned up in the mud."	Yes: petrified earthen.
5	"Helga ran off with a gnome lover."	No, though Zixxle was at the camp.
6	"At night you can hear something singing under the mud."	Yes: the Clay Rune resonates.

Scene 2: The trogg quarry

Rule of the scene
Combat or understanding. Every scene with troggs allows two ways out: fight, or understand what they are fleeing.

Tobrin asks for help clearing a quarry east of the village, where the attacks come from. It is an introductory fight: **6 troggs** and **1 trogg shaman** (Appendix A).

If the characters capture or calm a trogg and manage to communicate (in Dwarvish or Terran, or with a DC 14 Wisdom (Animal Handling) check through gestures), it babbles that "the Broken Voice" drove them out of their tunnels and that "the purple ones cut the stone that sings." The troggs are fleeing something, not attacking for pleasure: a compassionate group can avoid half the fight.

Rewarding compassion
If the group resolves the quarry without slaughtering the troggs, Tobrin, moved or puzzled, gives them a flask of Alchemist's Fire and League reputation rises by 1. The troggs are also deformed descendants of the earthen: an echo of the central theme.

Scene 3: The ruined camp

1. **The camp** (read the location).
2. **Investigation.** Intelligence (Investigation) DC 12: there was a fight; the attackers were humans and dwarves; they dragged someone towards the lakebed. On a DC 15, they

find **Helga's journal** (Player handouts) hidden under a plank.

3. **Zixxle Wirecutter** is hiding in a barrel, trembling. He joins the group if treated kindly.
4. **The cultists return. 4 Twilight's Hammer cultists** (Appendix A) and **1 cultist fanatic** (SRD 5.2) come back for toolboxes. If the characters hide, they can follow them to the crypt; if they question a survivor, it reveals the name "Sister Vessa" and that "the prophet needs the first word."

▲ **Milestone.** The characters reach **level 2** at the end of this scene.

The Clay Crypt

Read "The slab in the lakebed." The rooms are numbered on the map.

C1. Water Vestibule

A flooded floor and walls engraved with a metal giant shaping men of stone. Intelligence (History or Religion) DC 13 identifies Khaz'goroth, the Shaper. Two **mud mephits** lurk in the water: use the dust mephit stat block from the SRD 5.2, with a breath that blinds with mud instead of dust.

C2. Gallery of the Sleepers

Twelve earthen statues in niches. Three of them are **earthen stone sentinels** (Appendix A) that activate if someone carries twilight crystals or uses Void magic. If the characters show respect (kneel, speak Terran or succeed on a DC 14 Charisma (Persuasion) check before the central statue), the sentinels let them pass and may even fight beside them in C5.

C3. The Song of Form

A circular door with four sockets, each bearing a symbol: **stone**, **fire**, **water** and **breath**. Above it is an inscription in Terran, translatable with *Comprehend Languages* or a DC 15 Intelligence (History) check:

> *First was the rock, that knew not what it was. / Then fire made it hard and gave it bounds. / Water cooled it so it would not break. / And breath called it, so that it would answer.*

Correct order: stone, fire, water, breath. Each mistake gives a shock to whoever touched the socket: Constitution saving throw DC 12; 1d6 Thunder damage on a failure, half on a success. After the third mistake, any sentinel left in C2 activates.

C4. Hall of Moulds

Rows of empty moulds shaped like dwarven bodies, caked in mud. A wounded cultist lies dying here: "Vessa opened it... it sings... the flesh sings." In the mud, an attentive character (Wisdom (Perception) DC 13) finds a **Ring of Protection** lost by an explorer long ago.

C5. The Rune Niche

> The room is a perfect dome. In its centre, a hand's breadth above a pedestal, floats a rune of red clay the size of a shield, turning slowly. A deep sound flows from it, almost a voice. Before it, a woman in a violet robe chants in a language that scrapes your ears, and at her feet, in chains, a grey-haired dwarf looks at you and says: "You're late, but not entirely."

Main encounter. Vessa the Ash and **2 cultists** (Appendix A), and **1 earthen stone sentinel** that Vessa has corrupted with a twilight crystal. Destroying the crystal (AC 12, 5 HP) frees the sentinel and turns it against her.

The ritual. It completes at the end of round 4. If it does, Vessa flees with the rune through a rift and the group must chase her through the trogg tunnels (see "Chase" in Chapter 3; use 4 stretches instead of 6).

When Vessa falls, the air darkens and a projection of Othrek appears:

> A dwarven silhouette made of purple smoke forms above the rune. Its beard is braided in the old League fashion and its eyes don't blink. "Helga. You always had a good eye for assistants. Keep it, then. Keep it well. All roads lead to the same anvil." And it dissolves like ash in water.

Close ▲

Helga, freed, recognises her old teacher's voice and explains the legend of the Anvil of the First Name in an incomplete version: she believes it is only a myth. She proposes taking the Clay Rune to Ironforge, but first going to Uldaman, where her notes point to the second vault. The characters reach **level 3**. League reputation +1.

The Clay Rune
See Appendix B. One character should carry it: it is useful, but it whispers. That way the player lives the temptation first-hand.



CHARACTERS OF LEVELS 4 TO 6 · 4–5 SESSIONS

Chapter 2: The Heart of Uldaman

> *"Who decides what the true form of a living thing is?"*
> — The Watcher of Uldaman

The characters reach level 4 as the journey begins. The group crosses the scorched Badlands to the League dig at Uldaman. There it competes with the Horde's Reliquary and with a band of renegade Dark Iron dwarves digging for the cult. In the depths, a titan Watcher tests the characters before handing over the Stone Rune, which reveals visions of the dwarves' origin. The cult's lieutenant, Grel Halfgloom, will try to snatch it.

Rule of the chapter
Diplomacy between rivals. The Reliquary is not the enemy, and the Dark Iron renegades are not their clan. The decisions of this chapter weigh on the next: record them on the tracking sheet.

The journey across the Badlands

Read the location. Three days of reddish rock, canyons and stifling heat. Roll on the table each day. Without enough water, each character makes a DC 10 Constitution saving throw per hour of travel or gains a level of Exhaustion.

1d8	Encounter (SRD 5.2 creatures unless noted)
1	**2 basilisks** in a gorge. A petrified survivor carries a partial map of Uldaman.
2	**4 giant vultures** follow the group, waiting for someone to fall.
3	A goblin caravan of the Bilgewater Cartel offers water at the price of gold. Haggling: Charisma (Persuasion) DC 14.
4	**1 ogre** and **3 renegade orcs**, neither Horde nor Alliance, demand a toll. Use the bandit stat block for the orcs.
5	Sandstorm: zero visibility for 1d4 hours. Wisdom (Survival) DC 13 to avoid losing half a day.
6	**2 black dragon wyrmlings** nest on a ledge. A reminder that Deathwing casts his shadow over the region.
7	A half-buried earthen statue; touched with the Clay Rune, it whispers a hint about the way (Advantage on the next navigation check).
8	Horde patrol: **4 warrior veterans**, orcs. They don't attack unless provoked. A good scene of diplomatic tension.

The Uldaman dig

1. **Arrival** (read "The face of Uldaman").
2. **Dagna Oldiron** runs the League camp. She explains that the Cataclysm opened new galleries and that three groups are racing to get in first: the League, the Horde's Reliquary, led by Magistrix Caelinde Sunshadow, and some Dark Iron dwarves digging on their own in the east wing who shoot at anyone who comes near.
3. **The Reliquary dilemma.** Caelinde proposes a truce: the Horde has no interest in the cult and knows the renegades work for it. She offers to share a map of the new galleries in exchange for access to the discs in the Library (U5). Accepting is practical but risky: if the characters mention it in Ironforge, Council reputation may drop by 1; if they refuse, the Reliquary will compete with them in U5 and U7.
4. **The Dark Iron renegades.** They are **5 Dark Iron renegades** (Appendix A) led by **Barga Soothammer** (bandit captain). They are not Moira's agents but an exiled band paid by the cult in crystals. Capturing one alive is **crucial for Chapter 3**: their testimony will prove the Dark Iron clan is not behind the conspiracy.

Uldaman: key locations

U1. Gate of the Faceless

To open the main gate, two mechanisms must be worked at once: Strength (Athletics) checks by two characters totalling 30 or more, or a *Knock* spell. Zixxle can build a hydraulic lever in 1 hour.

U2. Trogg Gallery

A nest of stone troggs: **8 troggs** and **Grimlok the Old** (ogre stat block from the SRD 5.2). The gallery is narrow: it favours those who fight in formation.

U3. Hall of the Custodians

2 gargoyles (titan stone custodians) guard a seal. They stop if a character shows the Clay Rune and succeeds on a DC 15 Charisma check, but then they demand an answer: "What are you made of?" Any sincere answer will do; a detected lie (with *Detect Thoughts*, or a Deception that doesn't beat their Passive Insight of 14) restarts the fight.

U4. Map Chamber

A star map in relief shows the positions of Uldaman, Ulduar and Uldum. With Intelligence (Arcana) DC 16, the characters deduce that Uldaman was a "warding vault," not a city. Here they can learn that there are three runes, if they don't know yet.

U5. Library of Discs

Hundreds of engraved metal discs. A character can spend 1 hour deciphering them: Intelligence (History) DC 15, with Advantage if Helga or Caelinde helps. They discover that the Keepers dismantled the Anvil "so that the flesh could not be

forced again." If there is no truce with the Reliquary, there will be a clash: **Caelinde** (mage) and **2 knights**, blood elves. None of them wants to die here.

U6. Bridge over the Abyss

A 30-metre stone bridge over a bottomless pit. Halfway across, surviving renegades (or fresh reinforcements) attack with blasting charges: Dexterity saving throw DC 13 or fall 10 feet onto a ledge and take 2d6 Bludgeoning damage.

U7. The Watcher's Hall

Read the location, then:

> When it speaks, dust falls from the columns: "Three words made the stone. One sleeps here. Who claims it, and for what?"

The **Watcher of Uldaman** (Appendix A) doesn't attack at once: it asks three questions. The players answer in character; the Game Master judges whether the answers show respect for the origin, humility and protective intent. Each satisfying answer grants Advantage on a final DC 16 Charisma (Persuasion) check.

1. "What is a people that forgets where it comes from?"
2. "If you could remake your people without their flaws, would you?"
3. "Who decides what the true form of a living thing is?"

If the group succeeds, the Watcher hands them the Stone Rune and deactivates forever, at peace. If they fail, or if anyone has 4 or more Whispers, the Watcher fights to "test the form" of those who claim it and yields when it drops below half its Hit Points. Either way, the rune ends up with the group.

▲ **Milestone.** The characters reach **level 5** on reaching U7.

U8. Chamber of the Mould: the vision

When they touch the Stone Rune, the whole group shares a vision. It is a key moment of the campaign: give it time.

> You see a workshop without walls beneath a sky of another colour. A bronze giant strikes stone figures with his hammer, and they open their eyes on the third blow. You see those figures dig, sing, build. And then you see something crawling beneath the earth, something with too many mouths, and you see the stone of their bodies turn soft, crack, bleed. The figures weep for the first time. And in their weeping, surprised, they embrace. Then the vision goes out.

The vision is deliberately ambiguous: it shows the Curse as horror and also as the origin of something new, the weeping and the embrace. It leaves room for the players to debate Othrek's argument.

Final ambush ▲

On the way out, **Grel Halfgloom** (oni, presented as a Twilight's Hammer ogre mage), **4 cultists** and **2 cultist fanatics** wait at the entrance. Grel is greedy: with a DC 16 Charisma (Persuasion or Deception) check and a tempting offer (gold, a magic item), he may agree to withdraw... and reveal that in Ironforge "someone in the Hall" works for the prophet. If defeated, he carries a letter from Othrek (Player handouts).

The characters reach **level 6** at the end of the chapter. League reputation +1; if a renegade was captured alive, record it.

Chapter 3: Cracks in Ironforge

> *"They tell me that in the true form no one dies."*
> — Bramdul Drytome's note

With two runes in hand, the group reaches Ironforge to deliver them to the Council and protect the third, which turns out to be on display in the Hall of Explorers. But the city is burning with suspicion: after Uldaman, the Dark Iron clan stands accused of collaborating with the cult. The characters must investigate a hidden cell, prevent an outbreak of violence between clans and unmask the mole. The chapter ends with a chase on the Deeprun Tram.

Rule of the chapter
Investigation against the clock. Three clues, of which two are enough, and a 6-segment Crisis Clock that advances while the group hesitates. The city won't wait.

Arrival in Ironforge

1. **The entrance** (read "Ironforge").
2. **Audience before the Council of Three Hammers.** Muradin listens with military interest; Falstad, impatiently; Moira, defensively, because the rumours point at her clan. If the characters present a renegade captured in Uldaman as evidence, Moira gains credibility and Dark Iron reputation rises by 1. The Council asks the group to investigate discreetly and guard the runes.

The investigation

Clue	Place	How it is found	What it reveals
A. The false inventory	Hall of Explorers	Checking the records (Investigation DC 14) or talking to the apprentices (Insight DC 13).	The "rune piece" on display has been a replica for a month. Only Bramdul had the key to the case.
B. The gnome seer	Mystic Ward	Pibbly Eclipsby is terrified: he has seen a "face without a face" in his crystal ball.	He identifies a street speaker as a Faceless One in disguise.
C. The foundry cell	The Deeps	Following the speaker from the square (Stealth DC 14) or workers carrying purple crystals.	A warehouse with twilight crystals, robes and a marked plan of the Deeprun Tram. The sermon is found here (Player handouts).

The Crisis Clock

It advances one segment each time the group takes a Long Rest or fails an investigation check by 5 or more. It goes back one if the characters calm a public scene (Persuasion DC 15) or if Ambassador Kadra Smokeforge intervenes in their favour.

Segment	Consequence
2	Graffiti against the Dark Irons. Kadra asks the characters for help.
3	A mob stones a Dark Iron forge. Non-lethal fight against 8 commoners and 2 toughs (SRD 5.2). Stopping it without deaths: Dark Iron reputation +1.
4	Moira threatens to leave the Council. Council reputation –1.
6	Bramdul escapes with the runes before the group uncovers him. Go straight to the chase, with Bramdul 2 stretches ahead.

The revelation

When the group has two clues, SI:7 Agent Mara Voss steps forward: she has reached the same conclusion by another route. Bramdul is the mole. But when they reach his office in the Hall, they find it empty, as is the vault where the group's runes were kept (or the box a character carried, if Bramdul had a chance to get close: use whatever happened at the table).

> On Bramdul's desk, next to a cup still warm, is a small portrait of a dwarf girl with braids. On the back, in a shaky hand: "They tell me that in the true form no one dies. Forgive me, Helga."

If the players never let go of the runes
The group may have carried the runes at all times. In that case, Bramdul has kidnapped Helga and leaves a note: "The three words for the old woman. Lower platform, at midnight." The chase becomes an exchange that goes wrong. Both paths lead to Grim Batol.

Chase on the Deeprun Tram ▲

Read the location. Bramdul and his escorts have taken a freight car towards an abandoned maintenance tunnel, where a cult gryphon waits to fly them to the Highlands.

Chase. The tunnel is divided into **6 stretches**. Bramdul starts 1 stretch ahead. At the end of each round, each side advances one stretch; the group advances one more if at least half its members succeed on a group check (Strength (Athletics) to pump the car's lever, Dexterity (Acrobatics) to leap between cars or Intelligence to work the switches, DC 14). If the group catches Bramdul, combat begins. If Bramdul reaches stretch 6 uncaught, he escapes on the gryphon.

1d6	Complication of the round
1–2	A car coming the other way on the opposite track: Dexterity saving throw DC 14 or 3d6 Bludgeoning damage.
3	A seawater leak floods the floor: Difficult Terrain until the end of the next round.
4	A cultist uncouples a car: the group loses a stretch unless someone succeeds on Strength (Athletics) DC 15.
5–6	No complication.

Enemies. Bramdul (priest from the SRD 5.2 who replaces *Healing Word* with *Inflict Wounds*), **2 lesser Faceless Ones** (Appendix A) disguised as guards and **4 cultists**.

Bramdul is not evil. If someone speaks to him about his daughter with compassion (Charisma (Persuasion) DC 17, or DC 13 if Helga is present), he breaks down and hands over what he carries. But one of the Faceless Ones escapes with at least one rune: Othrek needs all three, and the story needs at least one to reach Grim Batol.

At the end of the chase, the characters reach **level 7**. When they prepare the assault of Chapter 4, they reach **level 8**.

Avoiding frustration

Some groups get annoyed if they "lose" something to the script. Make it clear that partial success matters: each recovered rune puts out one ring of the final ritual. Recovering two out of three should feel like a victory.

Chapter 4: The Anvil of Grim Batol

> *"You have come to watch your people be born. Good. Someone must remember it."*
> — Othrek Brokenvoice

The characters travel to the Twilight Highlands, where they must win the support of the Wildhammer clan and choose how to storm Grim Batol, the ancient dwarven fortress turned into a Twilight's Hammer stronghold and a breeding ground for corrupted dragons. In the heart of the mountain, Othrek has begun the reinscription ritual. The campaign is decided in a battle against time and against the villain's own argument.

Rule of the chapter
The ritual. Eight advances; each lit ring adds one per round. What the group achieved in earlier chapters (runes, reputation, allies) turns into time here.

The Twilight Highlands

1. **Arrival** (read the location).
2. **The Wildhammer stronghold.** Thane Kergan Highwind distrusts "city dwarves," but hates the cult more. To win his support, the group must pass one of these trials:
   - **The trial of the sky:** ride a wild gryphon (Animal Handling DC 15 and Athletics DC 13).
   - **The trial of honour:** rescue a patrol of riders trapped by **2 twilight drakes** (young black dragon from the SRD 5.2, with a breath that deals Necrotic damage instead of Acid).
   - **The trial of the word:** convince the council of elders with a speech (Persuasion DC 16; Advantage if Falstad vouched for the group or Wildhammer reputation is +2).

Choosing the assault

There are three routes to the Anvil Hall. The choice determines the first phase of the assault; the Game Master can combine elements.

Route	Requirement	Advantage	Risk
By air (A)	Wildhammer support	Fast arrival: the ritual starts in round 1 of the final battle, with no prior advances.	Aerial combat against twilight drakes on arrival.
Through the ancient tunnels (T)	Helga alive or the Uldaman map	Stealth: surprise in the final battle.	A maze with an otyugh and 2 ritual advances before arriving.
Diversion	Dark Iron or Council reputation +2	An army of Dark Iron and Ironforge attacks the gates: half the cultists are not in the Anvil Hall.	The inner gate must be opened from inside: group Stealth check DC 15.

Unity as a reward
If, on reaching this point, Dark Iron and Council reputation are both +2 or higher, the three dwarven factions attack together. Narrate it as the great moment of the campaign: the cult wanted to divide them and has united them.

Grim Batol

G1. The Hatching Halls

Corrupted dragon eggs embedded in violet crystal, guarded by **2 twilight drakes** and **1 cult oracle** (mage from the SRD 5.2 with enchantment spells). Destroying the eggs (each AC 15, 20 HP) weakens the ritual: for every 3 eggs destroyed, the ritual loses one advance.

G2. Hall of the Forgotten Kings

Statues of the ancient kings of the Wildhammer clan, desecrated. A Wildhammer character who stops to honour them for 1 minute gains the effects of *Bless* until the end of the final battle. **4 lesser Faceless Ones** wait here.

G3. The Anvil Hall

Read the location, then:

> And above the anvil, hammer in hand, Othrek Brokenvoice looks up. "You have come to watch your people be born. Good. Someone must remember it."

The final battle

Othrek Brokenvoice (Appendix A), **2 cultist fanatics** and **2 lesser Faceless Ones**. The hall has three runic rings, one per

rune. Othrek needs all three; if the group holds any, the matching ring is dark and the ritual advances more slowly.

The reinscription ritual

The ritual has **8 advances**. At the end of each round it gains 1 advance per lit ring (maximum 3). If it reaches 8, the prisoners transform into **Children of the Rift** (ghouls from the SRD 5.2 with cracked stone skin) and the effect begins to spread towards Ironforge: the group has 3 rounds to defeat Othrek before it becomes irreversible.

Putting out a ring (action): an adjacent character succeeds on an Intelligence (Arcana) DC 16, Wisdom (Religion) DC 16 or Strength (Athletics) DC 18 check to tear out the rune. A character carrying a recovered Rune of Form has Advantage: the runes "recognise each other." Each attempt is a *whisper*: Wisdom saving throw DC 15 or 1 Whisper.

Second phase: the Inverted First Name

When Othrek drops to 0 Hit Points, he merges with the anvil and is reborn as **Othrek, the Inverted First Name** (Appendix A). It is the moment of greatest tension.

> Othrek's body slumps onto the anvil... and the bronze absorbs it. For an instant there is silence. Then the surface of the metal cracks like old skin and from it rises something that still has his beard and his voice, but also eyes all along its arms and a mouth where the heart should be. "Do you see?" it says, almost tenderly. "This is what we are when we stop pretending."

Resolving without violence (optional)

A group that has paid attention to Othrek's argument can try to dismantle it instead of just striking him. In any round of the first phase, a character can use their action to address him with a solid argument: recalling the vision of Uldaman, where the weeping and the embrace were born in the flesh, but the flesh doesn't need the Void to be true. Three successes on Persuasion or Insight DC 18 before three failures make Othrek hesitate: he loses his Reaction and his Legendary Actions for 1 round per success. If Helga is present and joins in, two successes are enough. Othrek never surrenders, but he may die saying: "Perhaps... perhaps we were both right."

Adjusting the difficulty

For 4 characters of level 9, both phases of Othrek with his escorts are a deadly but beatable encounter, especially if rings are put out. For 5 characters or very optimised groups, add 1 lesser Faceless One in the second phase. For small groups, remove the fanatics.



Epilogue

> *"Let each of you say what should be done with the origin of a people."*
> — Helga Finestone

The characters reach **level 10** when they defeat Othrek. Choose the variant that fits what happened and read it at the Great Forge, or wherever the group ends up.

When the last ring goes out, the ash stops falling. The prisoners lift their heads as if waking from a very long dream, and the anvil, for the first time in millennia, falls silent.

[Ritual stopped, factions united] In Ironforge, the Council of Three Hammers emerges stronger. Moira and Falstad drink a toast together by the Great Forge, and Muradin laughs for the first time in months. They call you "Friends of the Stone," and each of you receives a gift from the three houses.

[Ritual stopped, factions divided] The cult has fallen, but graffiti keeps appearing in Three Hammers Square. Moira takes her seat with her jaw clenched. You have won the war; someone else will have to win the peace.

[Partial ritual] In a village in Dun Morogh, the dwarves wake with cracked skin and eyes of a faint violet. They don't attack. They ask questions. And no one knows whether they are monsters or a new people in need of protection.

[Ritual complete] The transformation advances across Khaz Modan like a slow tide. Someone has to find Brann Bronzebeard and the way to Ulduar, where the anvil was born, before no one is left who remembers the old form.

[If Bramdul survived] The archivist spends his days in the Hall, restoring the discs he stole. Beside his desk is a small portrait of a girl with braids. He no longer asks it for anything.

The fate of the Anvil

The players must decide what to do with it: hand it to the League, destroy it (which requires a mission to Ulduar) or leave it in the keeping of the Wildhammers. It makes a good final roleplaying scene, with no roll: let each character say what they believe should be done with the origin of a people.

Rewards

- The characters receive the **Tabard of the Radiant Lion** if Council reputation is +2 or higher (Appendix B).
- If the three dwarven factions attacked together, each character chooses a rare item.

Hooks for further play

- **Ulduar.** If the ritual was completed, only the place where the Anvil was born can reset it. A follow-up campaign, levels 11 to 15.
- **The remade.** A new people of dwarves with cracked skin asks for a place in the world.
- **The Reliquary.** Caelinde took copies of the Uldaman discs. Silvermoon now knows what Othrek knew.
- **The Council.** The tensions between clans are not over. A second campaign of political intrigue awaits in Ironforge.

Appendix A: Stat Blocks

> *"A test, not destruction."*
> — The Watcher of Uldaman

The stat blocks follow the format of the 2024 edition of the rules. All of them are original to this campaign; creatures without a stat block here come from the SRD 5.2 (next table). Values are provisional until the setting book is published.

Abbreviations. AC: Armor Class. HP: Hit Points. CR: Challenge Rating. XP: experience points. PB: Proficiency Bonus. DC: Difficulty Class. MOD: modifier. SAVE: saving throw.

Stat blocks by Challenge Rating

Original stat block	CR	Chapters
Othrek, the Inverted First Name	9	4
Othrek Brokenvoice	9	4
The Watcher of Uldaman	7	2
Lesser Faceless One	5	3, 4
Vessa the Ash	2	1
Earthen stone sentinel	2	1
Dark Iron renegade	1	2
Trogg shaman	1	1
Trogg	1/2	1, 2
Twilight's Hammer cultist	1/4	1–4

SRD 5.2 creatures cited

Look up their stat blocks in the SRD 5.2 or the 2024 *Monster Manual*.

SRD 5.2 creatures

SRD 5.2 creature	Use in the campaign
Cultist Fanatic	Chapters 1–4
Dust Mephit	Mud mephits, C1
Bandit Captain	Barga Soothammer
Bandit	Renegade orcs
Basilisk	Journey
Giant Vulture	Journey
Ogre	Journey; Grimlok
Black Dragon Wyrmling	Journey
Warrior Veteran	Horde patrol
Gargoyle	Custodians of U3
Mage	Caelinde; cult oracle
Knight	Reliquary escort
Oni	Grel Halfgloom
Priest	Bramdul
Commoner / Tough	The mob
Young Black Dragon	Twilight drakes
Otyugh	Grim Batol tunnels
Ghoul	Children of the Rift
Mule	Caravan

Trogg

Medium Humanoid (trogg), Chaotic Neutral

AC 13 (natural armor)
Initiative +1 (11)
HP 19 (3d8 + 6)
Speed 30 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
STR	14	+2	+2	DEX	12	+1	+1	CON	14	+2	+2
INT	6	−2	−2	WIS	10	+0	+0	CHA	6	−2	−2

Skills Stealth +3
Senses Darkvision 60 ft.; Passive Perception 10
Languages Trogg; understands a few words of Terran
CR 1/2 (XP 100; PB +2)

Traits

Stone Fury. While it has half its Hit Points or fewer, it has Advantage on melee attack rolls.

Stench of the Deep. A creature that starts its turn within 5 feet of the trogg makes a DC 11 Constitution saving throw or has the Poisoned condition until the start of its next turn.

Actions

Multiattack. The trogg makes two attacks: one with *Claw* and one with *Rock*.

Claw. *Melee Attack Roll:* +4, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 4 (1d4 + 2) Slashing damage.

Rock. *Melee Attack Roll:* +4, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 5 (1d6 + 2) Bludgeoning damage. It can also throw it: *Ranged Attack Roll:* +3, range 20/60 ft. *Hit:* 5 (1d6 + 2) Bludgeoning damage.

Trogg Shaman

Medium Humanoid (trogg), Chaotic Neutral

AC 13 (natural armor)
Initiative +1 (11)
HP 22 (4d8 + 4)
Speed 30 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
STR	12	+1	+1	DEX	12	+1	+1	CON	12	+1	+1
INT	8	−1	−1	WIS	14	+2	+2	CHA	10	+0	+0

Senses Darkvision 60 ft.; Passive Perception 12
Languages Trogg, Terran
CR 1 (XP 200; PB +2)

Traits

Stone Fury. While it has half its Hit Points or fewer, it has Advantage on melee attack rolls.

Actions

Bone Staff. *Melee Attack Roll:* +3, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 4 (1d6 + 1) Bludgeoning damage.

Spellcasting. The shaman casts one of the following spells, using Wisdom as the spellcasting ability (spell save DC 12): *1/Day Each: Cure Wounds*, *Thunderwave*.

Bonus Actions

Cry of the Rift (Recharge 5–6). Up to two allied troggs within 30 feet that can hear it move up to half their Speed without provoking Opportunity Attacks.

Twilight's Hammer Cultist

Medium Humanoid (any species), Chaotic Evil

AC 12 (leather armor)
Initiative +1 (11)
HP 13 (3d8)
Speed 30 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
STR	11	+0	+0	DEX	12	+1	+1	CON	10	+0	+0
INT	10	+0	+0	WIS	11	+0	+0	CHA	12	+1	+1

Skills Deception +3, Religion +2
Senses Passive Perception 10
Languages Common plus one other language
CR 1/4 (XP 50; PB +2)

Traits

Twilight Whisper. When it drops to 0 Hit Points, each creature within 10 feet of it makes a DC 11 Wisdom saving throw. *Failure:* it gains 1 Whisper, or has the Frightened condition until the end of its next turn if that rule isn't used.

Actions

Ritual Dagger. *Melee Attack Roll:* +3, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 3 (1d4 + 1) Piercing damage plus 2 (1d4) Psychic damage.

Vessa the Ash

Medium Humanoid (human), Chaotic Evil

AC 13 (studded leather armor)
Initiative +2 (12)
HP 45 (10d8)
Speed 30 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
STR	10	+0	+0	DEX	14	+2	+2	CON	10	+0	+0
INT	12	+1	+1	WIS	13	+1	+3	CHA	16	+3	+3

Skills Deception +5, Religion +3
Senses Passive Perception 11
Languages Common, Terran (by rote)
CR 2 (XP 450; PB +2)

Traits

Twilight Whisper. When it drops to 0 Hit Points, each creature within 10 feet of it makes a DC 12 Wisdom saving throw. *Failure:* it gains 1 Whisper, or has the Frightened condition until the end of its next turn if that rule isn't used.

Ceaseless Chant. While Vessa doesn't have the Incapacitated condition, the ritual in C5 keeps advancing even if she does other things.

Actions

Multiattack. Vessa makes two *Ritual Dagger* attacks or uses *Violet Rift* once.

Ritual Dagger. *Melee Attack Roll:* +4, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 4 (1d4 + 2) Piercing damage plus 3 (1d6) Psychic damage.

Violet Rift. *Wisdom Saving Throw:* DC 13, one creature Vessa can see within 60 feet. *Failure:* 11 (2d10) Psychic damage. This is a whisper. *Success:* Half damage.

Reactions

Shield of Faith. *Trigger:* An attack hits Vessa while an allied cultist is within 5 feet of her. *Response:* The cultist takes the attack instead.

Earthen Stone Sentinel

Medium Construct, Lawful Neutral

AC 17 (natural armor)
Initiative –1 (9)
HP 45 (6d8 + 18)
Speed 20 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
STR	16	+3	+3	DEX	9	–1	–1	CON	16	+3	+3
INT	6	–2	–2	WIS	12	+1	+1	CHA	5	–3	–3

Resistances Bludgeoning, Piercing, Slashing
Immunities Poison, Psychic; Charmed, Exhaustion, Frightened, Paralyzed, Petrified, Poisoned
Senses Darkvision 60 ft.; Passive Perception 11
Languages understands Terran but can't speak
CR 2 (XP 450; PB +2)

Traits

False Appearance. While motionless, it is indistinguishable from a statue.

Void Aversion. It has Advantage on attack rolls against creatures carrying twilight crystals or with 3 or more Whispers.

Actions

Multiattack. The sentinel makes two *Fist* attacks.

Fist. *Melee Attack Roll:* +5, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 7 (1d8 + 3) Bludgeoning damage.

Reactions

Guardian. *Trigger:* A creature within 5 feet of the sentinel attacks a target other than the sentinel. *Response:* The sentinel imposes Disadvantage on that roll.

Dark Iron Renegade

Medium Humanoid (dwarf), Neutral Evil

AC 16 (scale mail, shield)
Initiative +0 (10)
HP 26 (4d8 + 8)
Speed 25 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
STR	14	+2	+2	DEX	10	+0	+0	CON	14	+2	+2
INT	10	+0	+0	WIS	11	+0	+0	CHA	8	–1	–1

Resistances Fire
Senses Darkvision 120 ft.; Passive Perception 10
Languages Common, Dwarvish
CR 1 (XP 200; PB +2)

Traits

Paid in Crystals. It carries 1d4 twilight crystals. While it carries them, it has Advantage on saving throws to avoid the Frightened condition.

Actions

Multiattack. The renegade makes two *War Pick* attacks.

War Pick. *Melee Attack Roll:* +4, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 6 (1d8 + 2) Piercing damage.

Blasting Charge (1/Day). *Dexterity Saving Throw:* DC 12, each creature in a 10-foot-radius Sphere centered on a point within 30 feet. *Failure:* 10 (3d6) Fire damage. *Success:* Half damage.

Lesser Faceless One

Medium Aberration (shapechanger), Chaotic Evil

AC 14 (natural armor)
Initiative +2 (12)
HP 75 (10d8 + 30)
Speed 30 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
STR	16	+3	+3	DEX	14	+2	+2	CON	16	+3	+3
INT	13	+1	+1	WIS	12	+1	+4	CHA	15	+2	+5

Skills Deception +8, Insight +4
Resistances Necrotic, Psychic
Immunities Charmed
Senses Darkvision 120 ft.; Passive Perception 11
Languages Common, Dwarvish, Void Speech; telepathy 120 ft.
CR 5 (XP 1,800; PB +3)

Traits

Empty Face. A creature that starts its turn within 30 feet and can see the Faceless One's true form makes a DC 13 Wisdom saving throw or has the Frightened condition until the start of its next turn. This is a whisper.

Actions

Multiattack. The Faceless One makes two *Tentacle* attacks.

Tentacle. *Melee Attack Roll:* +6, reach 10 ft. *Hit:* 10 (2d6 + 3) Bludgeoning damage plus 5 (2d4) Psychic damage. If the target is Medium or smaller, it has the Grappled condition (escape DC 14).

Mind Drain (Recharge 5–6). *Intelligence Saving Throw:* DC 14, one creature Grappled by the Faceless One. *Failure:* 22 (4d10) Psychic damage, and the Faceless One regains Hit Points equal to half the damage dealt. *Success:* Half damage.

Bonus Actions

Shape-Shift. The Faceless One takes the appearance of a Small or Medium Humanoid it has seen, or returns to its true form. Its equipment doesn't change.

The Watcher of Uldaman

Large Construct, Lawful Neutral

AC 17 (natural armor)
Initiative –1 (9)
HP 142 (15d10 + 60)
Speed 30 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
STR	20	+5	+5	**DEX**	8	–1	–1	**CON**	18	+4	+7
INT	14	+2	+2	**WIS**	16	+3	+6	**CHA**	14	+2	+2

Resistances Bludgeoning, Piercing, Slashing
Immunities Poison, Psychic; Charmed, Exhaustion, Frightened, Paralyzed, Petrified, Poisoned
Senses Truesight 120 ft.; Passive Perception 13
Languages Terran, Titan, Old Dwarvish
CR 7 (XP 2,900; PB +3)

Traits

A Test, Not Destruction. When the Watcher reduces a creature to 0 Hit Points, it becomes Stable and Unconscious instead of dying.

Magic Resistance. The Watcher has Advantage on saving throws against spells and other magical effects.

Actions

Multiattack. The Watcher makes two *Titan Hammer* attacks.

Titan Hammer. *Melee Attack Roll:* +8, reach 10 ft. *Hit:* 18 (3d8 + 5) Bludgeoning damage, and the target makes a DC 16 Strength saving throw or has the Prone condition.

Word of Form (Recharge 5–6). *Constitution Saving Throw:* DC 15, each creature of the Watcher's choice within 30 feet. *Failure:* 27 (6d8) Thunder damage, and the creature has the Restrained condition (its skin hardens) until the end of its next turn. *Success:* Half damage.

Othrek Brokenvoice

Medium Humanoid (dwarf), Lawful Evil

AC 17 (twilight scale mail, shield)
Initiative +0 (10)
HP 150 (20d8 + 60)
Speed 25 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
STR	14	+2	+2	**DEX**	10	+0	+0	**CON**	16	+3	+7
INT	18	+4	+8	**WIS**	14	+2	+6	**CHA**	16	+3	+3

Skills Arcana +8, Deception +7, History +12, Insight +6
Resistances Necrotic, Poison, Psychic
Senses Darkvision 60 ft.; Passive Perception 12
Languages Common, Dwarvish, Terran, Titan, Void Speech
CR 9 (XP 5,000, or 5,900 in lair; PB +4)

Traits

Legendary Resistance (2/Day). If Othrek fails a saving throw, he can choose to succeed instead.

Aura of Whispers. A creature that starts its turn within 10 feet of Othrek makes a DC 16 Wisdom saving throw or can't take Reactions until the start of its next turn. This is a whisper.

Actions

Multiattack. Othrek makes two *Twilight Hammer* attacks, or one and uses *Spellcasting* to cast a cantrip.

Twilight Hammer. *Melee Attack Roll:* +6, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 6 (1d8 + 2) Bludgeoning damage plus 7 (2d6) Psychic damage.

Rift of the World (Recharge 5–6). *Dexterity Saving Throw:* DC 16, each creature in a 20-foot-radius Sphere centered on a point within 60 feet. *Failure:* 27 (6d8) Bludgeoning damage, and the creature has the Prone condition. *Success:* Half damage. The area becomes Difficult Terrain.

Spellcasting. Othrek casts one of the following spells, using Intelligence as the spellcasting ability (spell save DC 16, +8 to hit with spell attacks): *At Will: Chill Touch, Mage Hand. 3/Day Each: Blight, Hold Person, Shatter. 1/Day: Wall of Stone.*

Legendary Actions

Legendary Action Uses: 3. Immediately after another creature's turn, Othrek can expend a use to take one of the following actions. He regains all expended uses at the start of each of his turns.

Strike. Othrek makes one *Twilight Hammer* attack.

Directed Whisper. *Wisdom Saving Throw:* DC 16, one creature within 60 feet that can hear him. *Failure:* it gains 1 Whisper and has the Frightened condition until the end of its next turn.

Strike the Anvil (Costs 2 Uses). If Othrek is within 5 feet of the anvil, the ritual gains 1 additional advance.

Othrek, the Inverted First Name

Large Aberration, Lawful Evil

AC 16 (natural armor)
Initiative +1 (11)
HP 110 (13d10 + 39)
Speed 30 ft., Climb 30 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
STR	20	+5	+5	DEX	12	+1	+1	CON	16	+3	+7
INT	18	+4	+4	WIS	14	+2	+6	CHA	18	+4	+8

Vulnerabilities Radiant
Resistances Bludgeoning, Necrotic, Piercing, Slashing
Immunities Psychic; Charmed, Frightened
Senses Truesight 60 ft.; Passive Perception 12
Languages as before; telepathy 120 ft.
CR 9 (XP 5,000; PB +4)

Traits

Flesh That Remembers. At the start of each of his turns, Othrek regains 10 Hit Points if at least one runic ring is lit.

Hundred Eyes. Othrek can't be surprised, and attack rolls against him never have Advantage from his being unable to see the attacker.

Actions

Multiattack. Othrek makes three attacks: two with *Arm* and one with *Heart Mouth*.

Arm. *Melee Attack Roll:* +9, reach 10 ft. *Hit:* 14 (2d8 + 5) Bludgeoning damage.

Heart Mouth. *Melee Attack Roll:* +9, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 16 (2d10 + 5) Piercing damage plus 9 (2d8) Psychic damage.

Reinscribe (Recharge 5–6). *Charisma Saving Throw:* DC 16, one creature within 30 feet. *Failure:* it has the Charmed condition until the end of its next turn, must use its action to attack an ally and gains 1 Whisper.

Legendary Actions

Legendary Action Uses: 2. The same options as in the first phase, with an *Arm* attack instead of *Strike*.

Appendix B: Magic Items

> *"The runes want to return to the anvil."*
> — Discs of Uldaman

Items the characters can receive during the campaign, with the moment they are obtained. The three Runes of Form are the heart of the story; the rest are rewards.

Clay Rune

Wondrous Item, Rare (Requires Attunement)
Where it is found: Chapter 1, in the Rune Niche (C5).

A rune of red clay the size of a shield, warm to the touch, humming with a deep vibration.

Shape the Clay. As a Magic action, you choose a 5-foot Cube of earth, mud or clay you can see within 30 feet and excavate it, pile it up or turn it into Difficult or normal terrain. The change lasts 1 hour.

Passage of Form. Once per Long Rest, you can cast *Pass without Trace*. You have Advantage on checks to detect titan constructs.

Whisper. When you attune to it, you gain 1 Whisper.

Stone Rune

Wondrous Item, Rare (Requires Attunement)
Where it is found: Chapter 2, from the Watcher of Uldaman (U7).

A rune of grey basalt that, to anyone who stares long enough, shows glimpses of a workshop without walls.

Memory of the Stone. You have Advantage on Intelligence (History) checks. Once per Long Rest, you can cast *Legend Lore* without Material components on a titan object or place.

Whisper. When you attune to it, you gain 1 Whisper.

Metal Rune

Wondrous Item, Very Rare (Requires Attunement)
Where it is found: Chapter 3, the real one, held by Bramdul.

A rune of bluish steel, cold as well water, that never tarnishes.

Iron Will. You have Advantage on saving throws to avoid the Charmed condition. Once per Long Rest, when you fail a saving throw, you can take a Reaction to reroll it.

Whisper. When you attune to it, you gain 1 Whisper.

Carrying all three runes
A creature attuned to all three gains Resistance to Psychic damage, but at each dawn it makes a DC 15 Wisdom saving throw or gains 1 Whisper. The runes want to return to the anvil.

League Compass

Wondrous Item, Uncommon
Where it is found: Chapter 1 or 2, a gift from Helga or Dagna Oldiron.

A brass compass whose lid was hand-engraved by some bored explorer.

Once per day, you can ask it about a ruin or place you have seen on a map: the needle points towards it for 1 hour.

Helga's Hammer

Weapon (Light Hammer), Uncommon
Where it is found: Epilogue or Chapter 4: Helga gives it to whoever helped her most.

An archaeologist's hammer with a worn leather grip and a head full of nicks.

You have a +1 bonus to attack and damage rolls made with this weapon. It has 3 charges; as a Magic action, you expend one to cast *Detect Magic* or *Identify* on an object you tap gently with it. It regains 1d3 charges at dawn.

Gryphon-Feather Cloak

Wondrous Item, Uncommon (Requires Attunement)
Where it is found: Chapter 4, reward from the Wildhammer clan.

A cloak of brown and golden feathers that stirs even when there is no wind.

You can cast *Feather Fall* on yourself at will. Once per Short Rest, you can jump three times your normal distance.

Tabard of the Radiant Lion

Wondrous Item, Rare (Requires Attunement by a Creature Loyal to the Alliance)

Where it is found: Epilogue, if Council reputation is +2 or higher.

A blue-and-gold tabard blessed in Stormwind's Cathedral of Light.

While you wear it, you and your allies within 10 feet of you have Advantage on saving throws against whisper effects.

The flask of Alchemist's Fire and the Ring of Protection that appear in Chapter 1 come from the SRD 5.2.

Appendix C: To Be Adjusted with the Setting Book

This campaign was written before the setting book was published. Once it is available, the following points should be reviewed.

- ☐ Trogg statistics, which are original stat blocks here.
- ☐ Playable species: if the book includes Dark Iron and Wildhammer dwarves, draenei or worgen, replace the adaptations in "Azeroth at the table."
- ☐ Classes and subclasses matching those of *Warcraft* (especially the shaman).
- ☐ Challenge Ratings of the Watcher, the lesser Faceless Ones and both phases of Othrek.
- ☐ The earthen sentinel's resistances, which may prove harsh for 1st-level characters.
- ☐ Rarity and properties of the Runes of Form and the other items in Appendix B.
- ☐ Reputation and Whispers rules, if the book offers systems of its own.
- ☐ Official names of places, factions and creatures.

Changes from the original draft

So that the campaign can be published as free fan content, these references to paid books have been replaced with material from the SRD 5.2 or with original rules:

- The Forge domain (*Xanathar's Guide to Everything*) is replaced with the Life or Light domains.
- The madness tables of the *Dungeon Master's Guide* are replaced with the Void Echoes.
- The chase rules of the *Dungeon Master's Guide* are replaced with the Chase of Chapter 3.
- Troglodytes, which are not in the SRD 5.2, are replaced with original trogg stat blocks.
- The mud mephit and the young purple worm are replaced with the dust mephit and the otyugh; the orcs, with bandits.
- The *Mold Earth* spell, which is not in the SRD 5.2, is replaced with an original property of the Clay Rune.
- The 2014 races and subraces are adapted to 2024 species.

Appendix D: Game Master Tools

> *"Brann may write letters, never solve problems."*
> — Running advice

Dwarf and gnome names

1d10	Dwarf	Gnome
1	Durgan Oldanvil	Tinkel Springwhimsy
2	Brenna Deepbrew	Fizzwick Nutloose
3	Thorgal Stoneaxe	Nixie Sparktooth
4	Grimna Ashbeard	Pozzik Littlecog
5	Hulrik Castchest	Bimble Voltstill
6	Dagrun Coldstone	Sprocka Tinybolt
7	Kazrim Broadhammer	Wizzle Clockburn
8	Olva Ironbraid	Glimmy Sequin
9	Magnar Rocksong	Trixx Leverling
10	Ysolda Gentlefire	Dobbin Loosewire

Suggested session plan

Session	Content
0	Character creation, bonds, safety tools. Explain Reputation and Whispers.
1	Arrival in Thelsamar, rumours, the trogg quarry.
2	Ruined camp, Zixxle, cultists. Level 2.
3–4	Clay Crypt, rescue of Helga. Level 3.
5	Journey across the Badlands. Level 4.
6	Uldaman dig, the Reliquary dilemma, U1–U3.
7–8	U4–U7, the Watcher. Level 5.
9	Vision, Grel's ambush. Level 6.
10	Arrival in Ironforge, audience before the Council.
11–12	Investigation and the Crisis Clock.
13	Revelation and chase on the Tram. Level 7.
14	Twilight Highlands, the Wildhammers. Level 8.
15	Assault on Grim Batol (G1–G2). Level 9.
16	Final battle and epilogue. Level 10.

Running advice

- **Let Othrek talk.** His strength is his argument, not his Hit Points. If the players hesitate, the campaign works.
- **Humanise the troggs and the Dark Irons.** The cult feeds on contempt for the "deformed" and the "traitors"; let the players see it.
- **Use Zixxle to lighten the mood.** After horror scenes, a gnomish invention exploding at the worst moment lets the table breathe.
- **Connect the backgrounds.** A worgen, a draenei or a Dark Iron dwarf has personal reasons to feel the theme of "imposed form." Ask them in session zero what they think about changing what one is.
- **Keep Brann offstage.** It is tempting to use the great heroes of *Warcraft*, but the campaign shines when the protagonists are the characters. Brann may write letters, never solve problems.

For the classroom

The Watcher's question, "who decides what the true form of a living thing is?", also works away from the table as a prompt for a debate about identity, origin and storytelling. The vision of Uldaman can be read alongside other creation myths of beings shaped from clay or stone.

TO GIVE TO THE PLAYERS

Player handouts

Print or read these texts when the characters find them.

Journal of Helga Finestone

hurried handwriting · Chapter 1

Day 3. *The lake has dropped another hand's breadth. The slab is titan work without a doubt: the greenish alloy, the edges without a single notch. Zixxle says his gadget is beeping "at Uldaman levels." For once I don't think he's exaggerating.*

Day 4. *I've recognised the inscription on the lintel. It's the same sequence Othrek used to copy obsessively into his notebooks, before the Hall threw him out. "Three words made the stone." He said it was a recipe. I told him it was a poem. I wish I had been right.*

Day 5. *Violet lights on the south shore. Tonight I sleep with my hammer.*

Letter found on Grel

Chapter 2

Grel: your price is high, but I will pay it. The second word is in the Watcher's memory. Don't face it: let Helga's friends convince it, and take the rune from them on the way out. The third is almost in my hands: our friend in the Hall has made an excellent replica. The anvil waits in the mountain of the forgotten kings. Don't be late.

— O.

Pamphlet found in the foundries · Chapter 3

BROTHERS AND SISTERS

They told us that flesh was a curse. But who told you so? The same ones who made you to dig. The ones who shaped you the way one shapes a pick. Look at your hands. They bleed, they tremble, they caress. Is that a disease? No: it is the first true gift. When the anvil sings, we will be what we always should have been, and no one will ever again die afraid.

Inscription of the Song of Form

door of C3 · Chapter 1

First was the rock, that knew not what it was.
Then fire made it hard and gave it bounds.
Water cooled it so it would not break.
And breath called it, so that it would answer.

